Forestry: An International Journal of Forest Research - Decision on Manuscript ID Forestry-2026-310

1 message

Forestry: An International Journal of Forest Research <onbehalfof@manuscriptcentral.com>
Reply-To: forestry.fassnacht@gmail.com
To: seamusrobertmurphy@gmail.com

Wed, Nov 4, 2026 at 1:51 PM

04-Nov-2026

Dear Dr. Murphy,

Thank you for submitting your manuscript Forestry-2026-310 entitled "A spruce beetle susceptibility map of Alaska using Sentinel-1 radar and crown-scale mortality data" which you submitted to Forestry: An International Journal of Forest Research. Apologies that it took us a while to get back to you.

I am sorry to say that after careful consideration of your manuscript I have decided not to progress it any further towards publication. The main reason for this is that I see relatively little innovation in the study. While I think that the validation effort you present is quite comprehensive, I missed a comparison of your SAR-based approach against the numerous established approaches based on optical remote sensing but also based on alternative SAR-methods. Given the huge amount of studies working on disturbance detection, your approach is comparably straightforward and this is not per se a problem, but you have to proof that it provides an advantage over other approaches. For example, one could also ask why Sentinel-2 has not been examined. At pixel size of 10 m, even smaller dieback areas should become visible.

Given that we also receive a very large number of submissions at the moment. we are unfortunately not able to consider your contribution for publication.

Thank you for considering the Journal for the publication of your research. I hope the outcome of this specific submission will not discourage you or your colleagues from the submission of future manuscripts.

Yours sincerely,

Fabian

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